BAPS Swaminarayan Sanstha, Australia Ltd

# SANSKARDHAM ESTABLISHMENT & OPERATIONAL GUIDELINES

## Applicable Centres

All BAPS Australia Regional Centres.

## Version Control

| Version | Date | Author / Owner | Approved by | Summary of Changes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1.**0** | 14/02/2026 | Regional Mandir Development Team | Pujya Paramchintan Swami | Initial Draft |

## Objective

These guidelines are to standardise the establishment and operation of Sanskardham (regional mandirs) across Australia. They also aim to promote consistency in practice, accountability, and operational efficiency.

## Sanskardham Location

- The location of Sanskardham is selected by the Pujya Kothari Sant of ANZ based on the history of the existing mandal and potential future growth.

## Acquisition of the Property

- Upon confirmation from the Pujya Kothari Sant, the local and national Sanskardham teams search for the property.
- The property will be acquired by one or two sevabhavi haribhakts. Our preference is for a property with an existing place of worship or religious use to avoid going through council approval, saving time and money.

## Development Application Process

Following the finalisation of the property, the development application process (if required) should start simultaneously with the property purchase. This process includes the following tasks:

- **Consultant Search**: Obtain fee proposals from various consultants including a Town Planner, Private Certifier, Architect, and other consultants/engineers. As per the Sanstha's policy, a minimum of three proposals should be obtained from each discipline.
- **Funding Proposal Submission**: The National Sanskardham team prepares a funding proposal for consultant engagement and submits it for BoT approval.
- **Consultant Appointment**: Subject to BoT approval, the National Sanskardham team will sign a fee variation to appoint consultants.
- **Pre-DA Meeting with Council**: If suggested by the town planner, the local and national Sanskardham teams will arrange a meeting with the council for the pre-DA application.
- **Lodgement of Application**: Upon finalisation of the plan and various reports, the DA application should be submitted to the council.

## Builder Tendering

- Once plans are finalised, the search for a builder should begin to obtain tenders from a minimum of three builders.
- Upon receiving quotes, the local team should meet with the national project admin and Sanskardham team to review the quotes and ensure they cover the required scope of work.

## Funding Proposal

- Once the builder is finalised, the National team will prepare a funding proposal and submit it to the BoT for approval.

## Sinhasan Fitting

- At least two weeks prior to the Pratistha Mahotsav, the National team shall coordinate with the team to schedule the Sinhasan fitting, including Kathedo.

## Pratistha Mahotsav

- Overall planning of the Pratistha Mahotsav is guided by the Pujya Santo, including the programme, timing, and external venue (if required).
- The centre coordinator will plan the detailed event with the local and surrounding centres' teams. The nearby metro centre coordinator and the Sanskardham national team will assist the centre coordinator as required. The major tasks of the Pratistha Mahotsav are as follows:
    - Mahotsav Programme
    - Nagar Yatra Venue Booking
    - Council or Local Authority approval for the Nagar Yatra
    - Inform the Admin Secretary of the event and expected visitors for Public Liability Insurance cover purposes.

## Seva Allocation and Roster

- With guidance from the Pujya Kothari Sant, the centre coordinator will allocate a seva lead for each department, including Thakorji seva. Prepare the Thakorji Seva and Thal roster.

## Mandir Opening Hours

- As per guidance from Pujya Santo, Sanskardham to be open for Darshan daily from 5:00 pm to 7:30 pm, except on days when there is a weekly Satsang Sabha or Samaiya/Mahotsav. On those special days, the opening hours should be adjusted as needed.

## Thakorji Thal and Seva

- Thakorji seva (Jagadva, Snan, Shringar, Thal, and Arti) to be performed in the evening.
- Anyone undertaking this seva must be both spiritually and physically pure. This involves maintaining personal cleanliness, wearing washed/cleaned clothes, and approaching the seva with deep devotion, care, and respect.

- This seva should be carried out regularly and punctually, following the schedule and guidelines provided by Pujya Santo.

## Satsang Reporting

- Center Coordinator to submit Satsang reports (Weekly and Para Sabha, Vimarsh and any Project related) in timely manner as requested by SDC.

## Accounts and Donations

- All donations, including murti and Sinhasan sponsorships, will be received in the regional account.
- Donation receipts for seva received at the counter, regardless of the mode of payment, will be prepared by the local account Karyakar, and receipts for EFT payments will be prepared by the National Account team.

## Expense Reimbursement

- All expense reimbursement claims must be submitted through Acumatica within 14 days of their occurrence.
- The centre coordinator must ensure that all claims are made within this time frame.